Video Production and Editing

ANTH 2315 Religion and Modernity
Dr. Carie Hersh
Fall 2026
Taught by Tiffany Cruz and Reba Dickson

Northeastern University
NULab for Digital Humanities and
Computational Social Science

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Discussion

- How was your experience recording for your project?
- What do you hope to convey with your editing today?

Workshop agenda

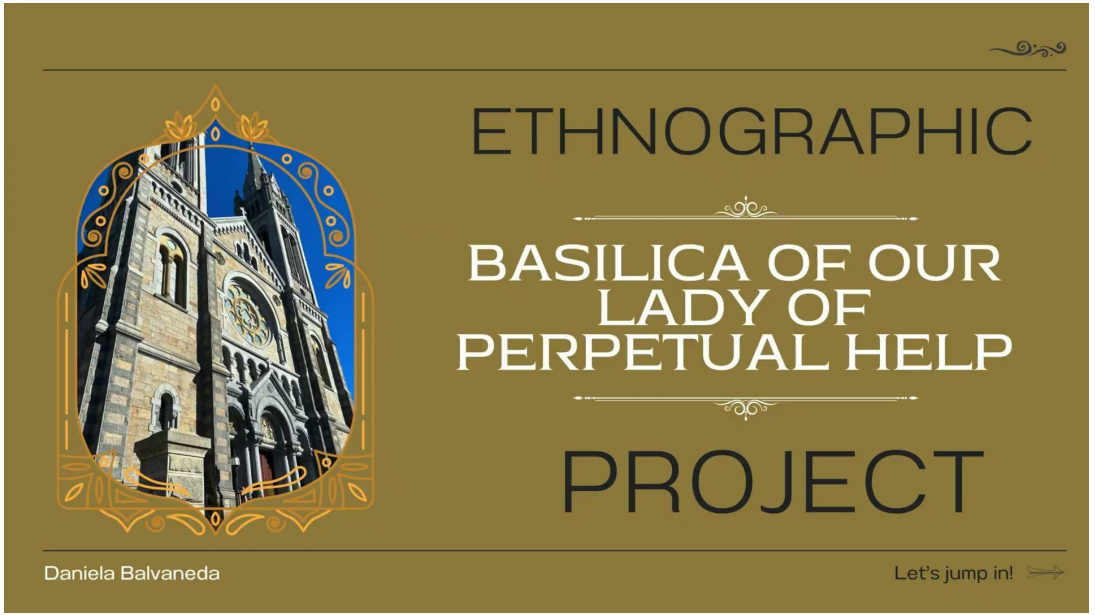
- Example
- Important questions
- Video production steps and common pitfalls
- In-class CapCut activity
- Discussion

Slides, handouts, and media available at https://bit.ly/fa26-hersh-videoediting

Example video

[Daniela Balvaneda, Cultural Anthropology, Ethnographic Project: Basilica of Our Lady of Perpetual Help]

Keep an eye out for editing techniques!



Important questions

- What main points are you trying to communicate to your audience?
- How can images and video help you communicate?
- How can you improve the accessibility of your presentation?

Video production steps

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Brainstorm on Video Editing

- What are some good practices for creating a video?
- Is there anything you already know about video editing or production?
- What video editing techniques did you notice in the example video? How did they contribute to it?

Steps

1) Draft a Script
2) Plan your Shots
3) Select the Location(s)
4) Develop the Schedule
5) Shoot
6) Edit Video

Check out this resource for more information: How to Make a Video

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

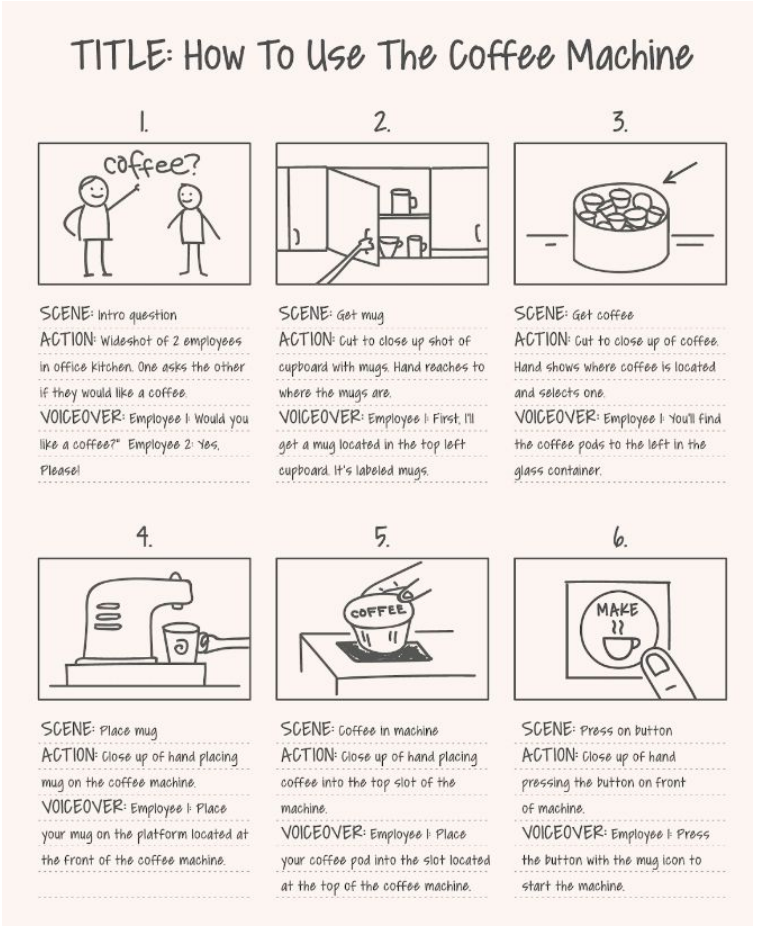
Script

- What you want to communicate
- Speaking points (refer to assignment guidelines)
  - Important facts from library research
  - Description of fieldsite and fieldwork experiences
  - Your main insight

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Storyboard or outline

- Once you know what you want to say, plan how you will say it “with video”
- **Storyboard:** timeline of scene sketches
- **Outline:** bulleted list of the scene descriptions



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What kinds of footage do you want?

- **Presentation:** a “host” reciting a script
- **B-roll:** “background” footage you can cut to any time
- **Cut-in:** close-ups of an object a subject is interacting with

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Make a shot list

- A **storyboard** or **outline** is a list of the shots and other information as it will appear in your video
- A **shot list** is a planning document—it's your to-do list of each individual thing you will need to film
  - For each shot, you'll need to plan a location and time to film it

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Location (1/2)

- Permissions
  - Time constraints
  - Avoid filming people
- Background noise
- Lighting
- Snell Library Recording Studios

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Location (2/2)

Pro/ Cons

- Windowless room
- Centennial Common (outside Ruggles)
- Over Zoom

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Schedule

- Date and time for shoots
  - Location limitations
  - Room reservations
- Buffer/makeup days
  - Weather
  - Transportation
- Time for editing

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Shoot

- Equipment
  - Phone camera or digital camera
  - Tripod
  - Fully charged
- Where to place camera
  - **The rule of thirds:** placing focal points at thirds in the image
- Review videos and images

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Edit video

- Integrate images and videos
- Adjust sound and voice over
- Background music
- Add titles or graphics

How to Make a Video
Video Editing Terms

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Vocabulary review (1/2)

- **Script:** the key information you want to convey, including specific words you want to use in narration (first document for video production)
- **Storyboard** or **outline**: two ways of planning out how your script will be connected to specific shots you'll film (second document you'll write)
- **Shot:** a single short video recording
- **Shot List**: a to-do list for all the shots you will need to create the video you've planned (third document you'll write)

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Vocabulary review (2/2)

- **The Rule of Thirds**: placing focal points at thirds in the image
- **Cut-in**: displays an object the subject is interacting with
- **B-Roll:** "background" or secondary footage you can cut to any time

See here for more information on video editing vocabulary: Video Editing Terms

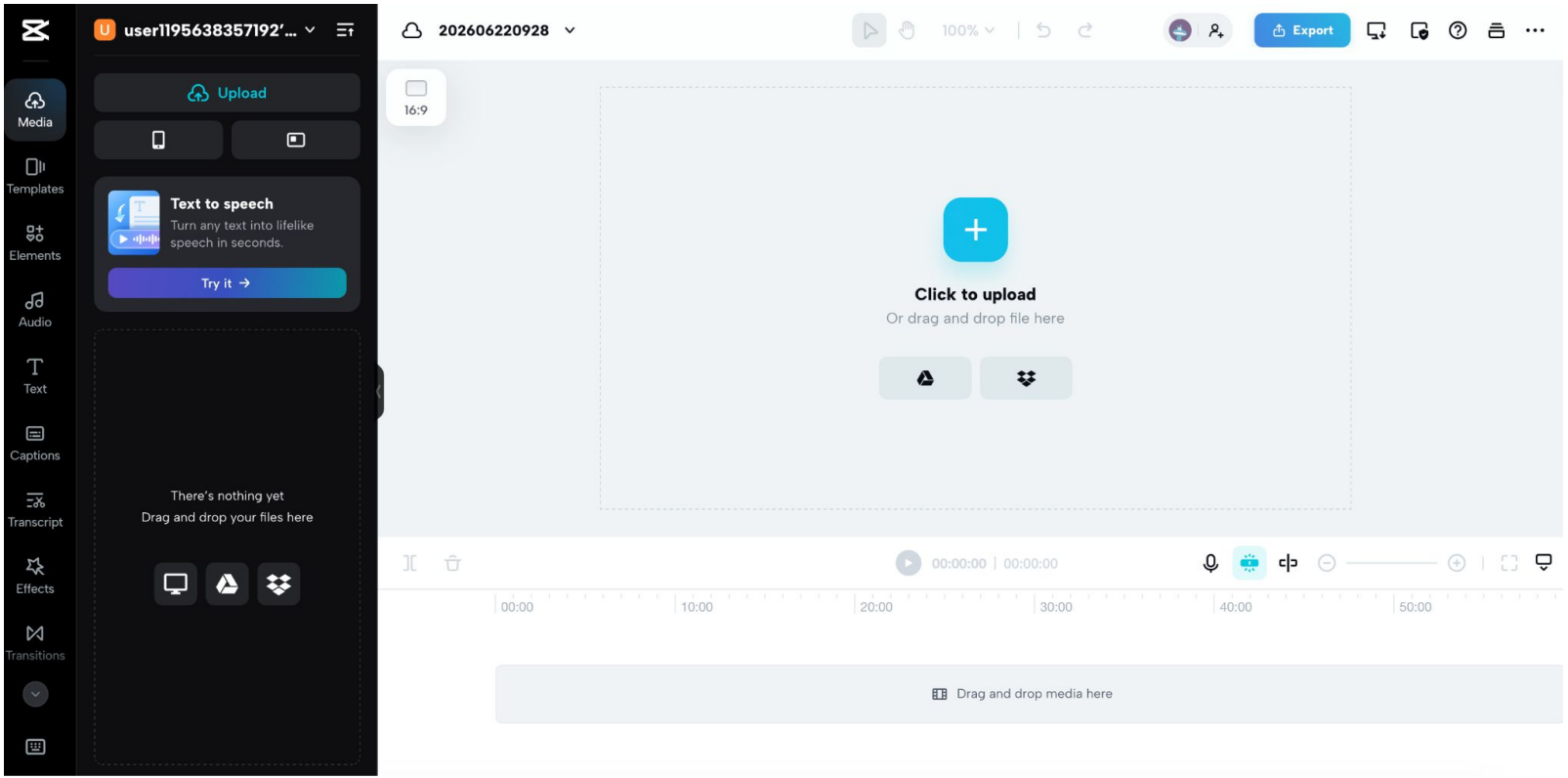
Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

CapCut video editor

CapCut video editor introduction

- Online video editing software suitable for beginners
- Work across multiple devices (laptop, phone, ipad)
- Basic account is free
  - Utilizes AI tools for editing
  - Templates available to use
  - Ability to add music, captions, transitions, and effects
- CapCut Video Editor

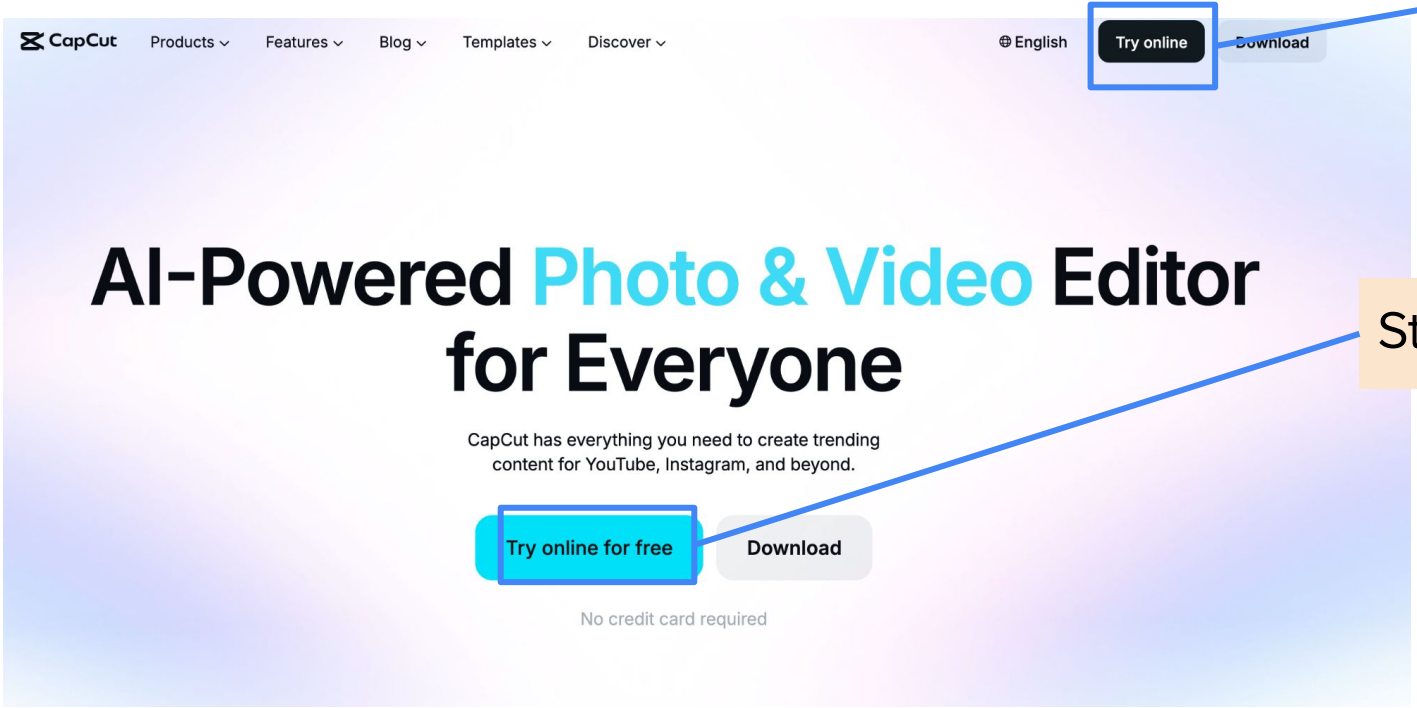
CapCut video editor layout



CapCut video editing steps

1. Create account or login and click ‘create new’
2. Choose video format
3. Upload media
4. Edit clips
5. Add any transitions, sound, or effects
6. Add text
7. Add captions
8. Export your video

Login and start editing

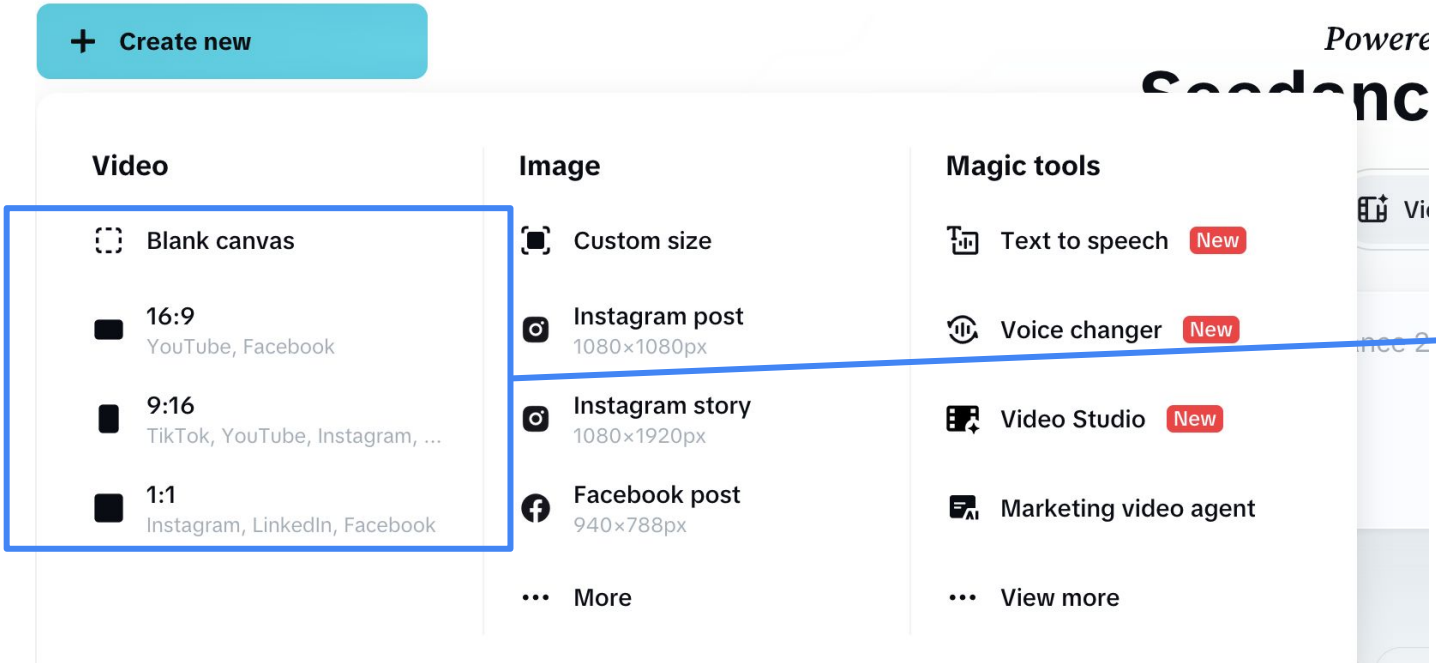


Click **Try Online.**

Start editing.

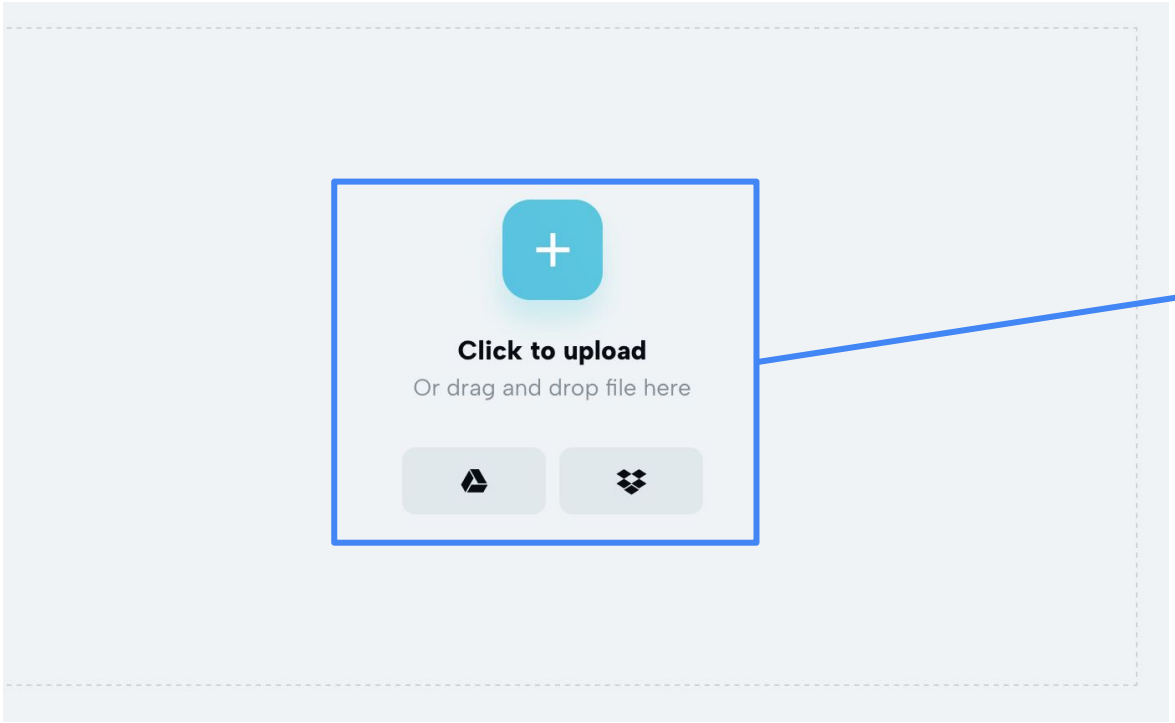
Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Choose video format



Click on **Create New** and then the video dimension you want to use.

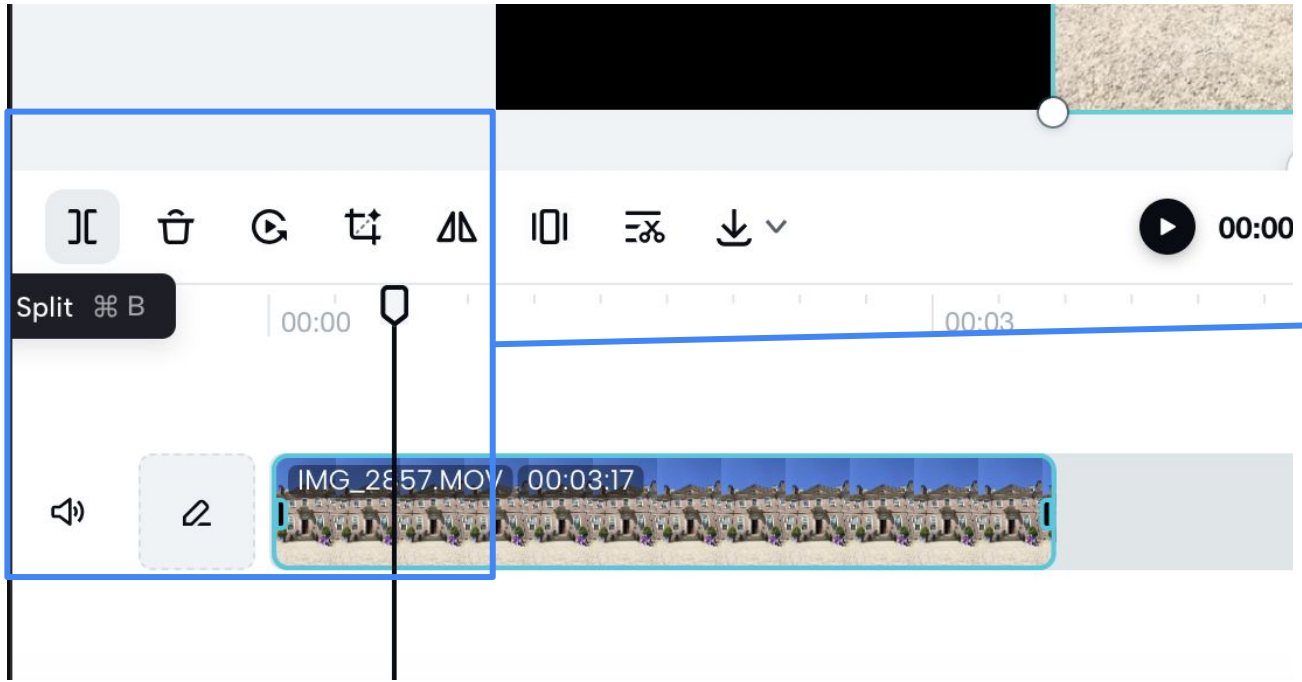
Upload media



Click to **Upload**, select the media type, and select the files from your computer.

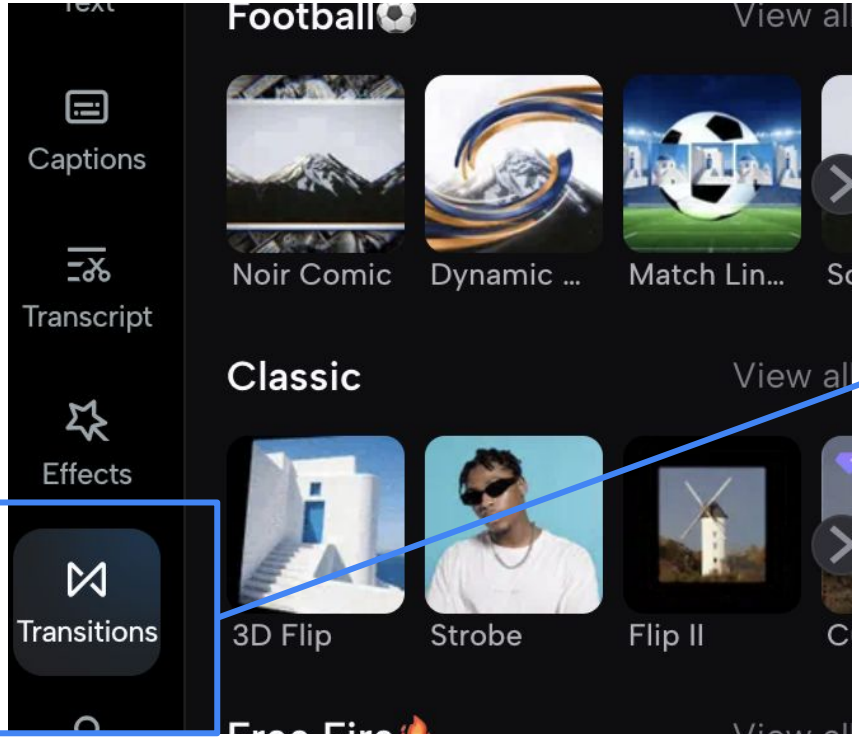
Files will be saved in the media section.

Edit Clips



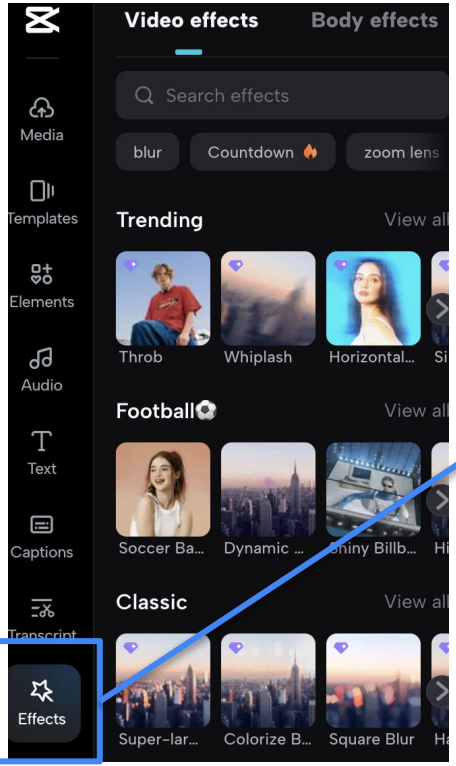
Add clips to **Timeline**, cut clips with the **Split** tool, or use **Command B**.

Add Transitions



Go to **Transitions** and select the one you want to use. You must have two video clips minimum to add a **Transition.**

Add Effects

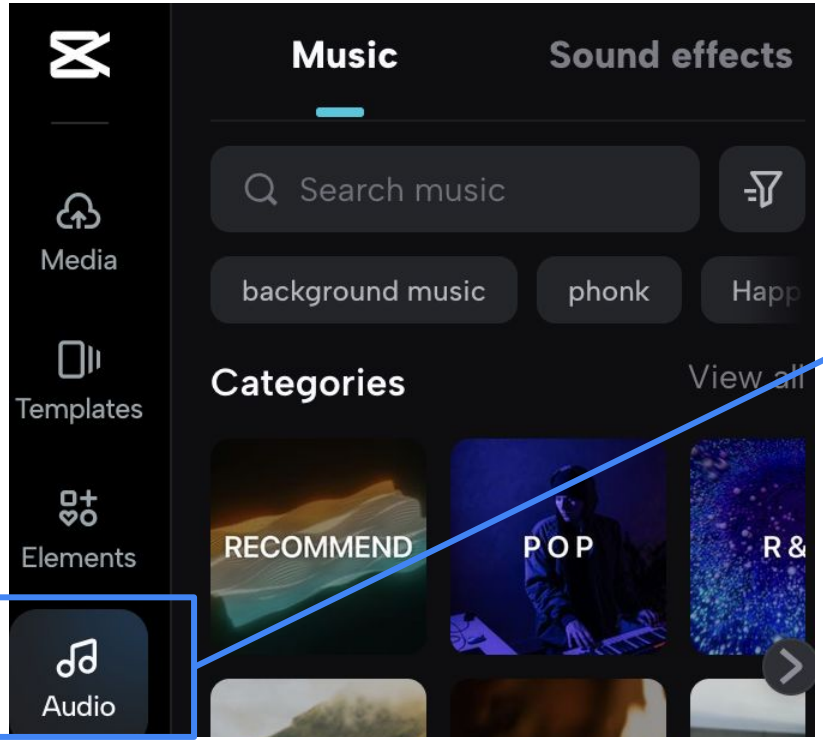


Add **Effects**. An effect is a technique that modifies your video clip. It can change the color or movement. Effects are useful for further customization and storytelling. Select either video effects or body effects.

All the **Effects**, without the purple diamond next to them are free to use.

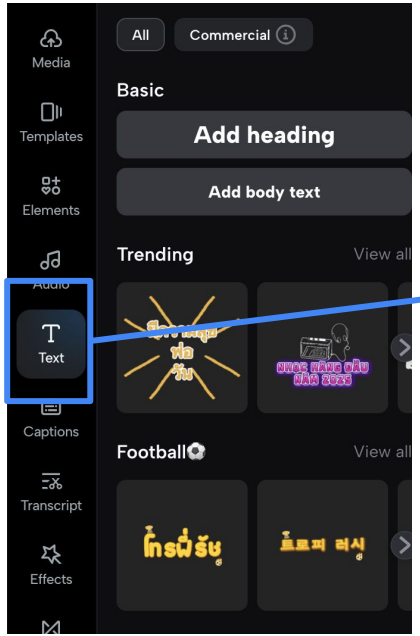
You can decide if you want the effect to be on the entire clip or part of it.

Add Sound



Add **sound.** You can pick either **music** or **sound effects.**

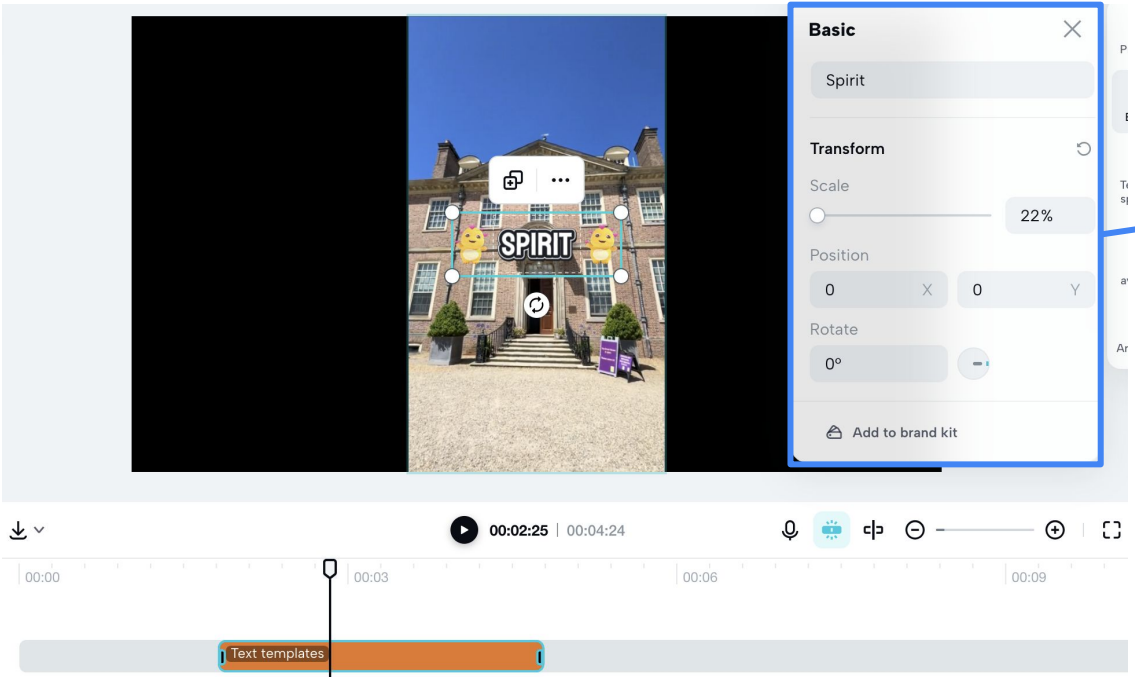
Add text 1/2



Select the **Text** option to choose fonts or text layouts.

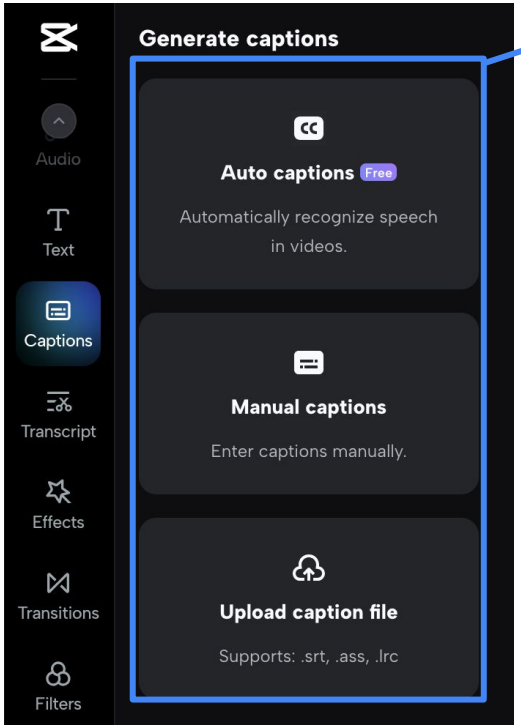
Text will generate onto your most recent clip selected.

Add text 2/2



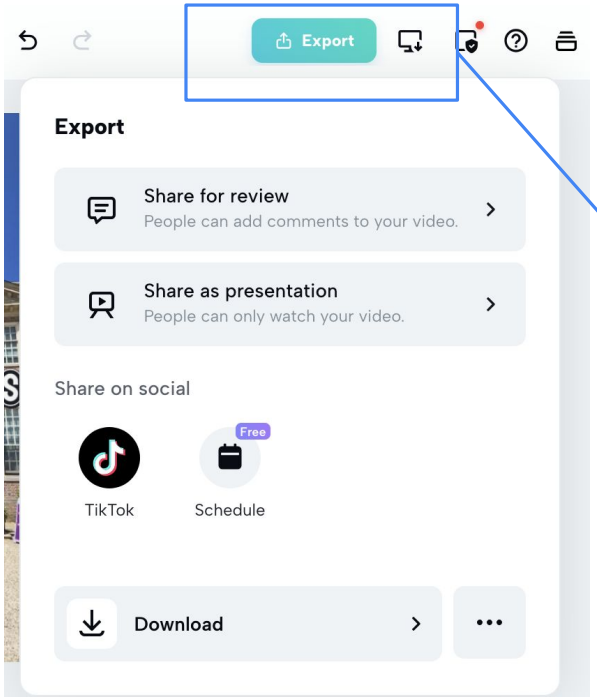
Edit the **text** and change font, size, and style.

Add captions

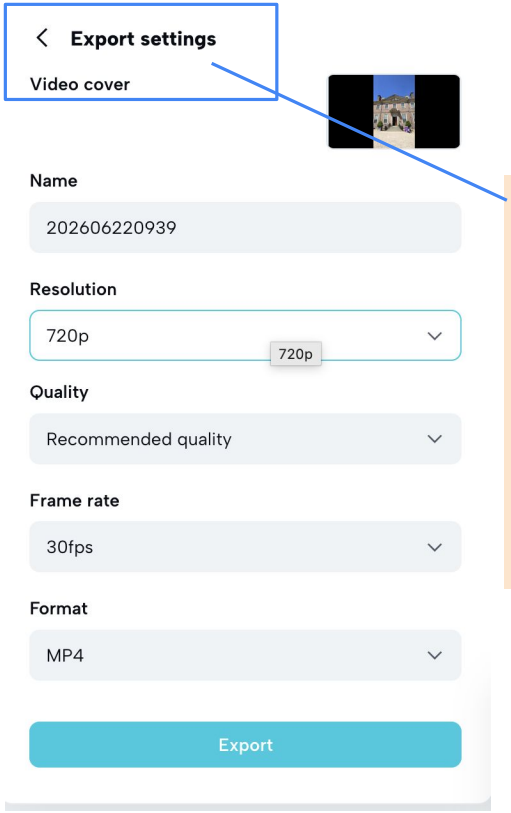


Add **Captions**. You can pick from three different options:
1) Auto captions (it is done automatically).
2) Manual captions (you type these yourself).
3) Uploading a caption file associated with the video.

Export your video



Click **Export** once you have finished editing your video



Add a **name**, pick the **resolution** you want, and choose the **format**.

Demonstration

1. Create account or login and click ‘create new’
2. Choose video format
3. Upload media
4. Edit clips
5. Add any transitions, sound, or effects
6. Add text
7. Add captions
8. Export your video

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Your turn!

1. Use sample media or use your own materials
2. Create a CapCut video editor account
3. Upload media
4. Edit clips
5. Add any transitions, sound, or effects
6. Add text
7. Add captions
8. Export your video

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Post-exploration group discussion

- What was successful about using CapCut? What was challenging or missing?
- What editing decisions did you make and why? How do they contribute to your purpose in making the video?

Tools, Tips & How to Avoid Common Pitfalls

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Other Free Video Editing Software

- Vimeo (basic)
- Lightworks
- VN Video Editor
- DaVinci Resolve (advanced)

Tips and Common Pitfalls: Image

- Avoid bright lights in your shot—they will make everything else look dark
  - Outside, move so the sun is to the left or right of a person—not right in their face to make them squint, but not behind them
  - Inside, check for a lamp or a bright window and consider moving so the light source is just outside the shot
- Record “extra” footage at the beginning and end of each shot (this makes it easier to edit it later)

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Tips and Common Pitfalls: Sound (1/2)

- **Test your mic** and technology before you start.
  - Your microphone may hear a lot more than you do! Record some test audio and play it back before you begin.
- **Have a plan** for the conversation and transitions.
  - Give yourself a script. As you record, mark out spaces for transitions in the recording (topic-to-topic, parts of the episode).

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Tips and Common Pitfalls: Sound (2/2)

- Turn off A/C units, consider closing windows, etc, if you can
- Mute device notifications
- Ideally, find a room with good sound absorption to prevent the "echo effect."
    - **Yes:** carpet, cushions, bookshelves, clothes (bedrooms, closets).
    - **No:** larger spaces with hard, smooth surfaces (kitchens, bathrooms).

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Thank you!

—Developed by Tiffany Cruz and Emily Sandercock alongside Sara Morrell and Johan Arango-Quiroga

- For more information on the DITI, please see: https://bit.ly/diti-about
- Schedule an appointment with us! https://bit.ly/diti-meeting
- If you have any questions, contact us at: nulab.info@gmail.com
- We'd love your feedback! Please fill out a short survey here: https://bit.ly/diti-feedback

Sample media

- Japanese Noh theater performance at the MFA
- Collection of Noh masks
- Image of Noh actor Kita Roppeita